

The reason we've spent so much time unpacking the elements that make up your Financial Phenotype in this book is that true behaviour change begins with identity change. As habits expert James Clear explains in his book, *Atomic Habits*, 'You might start a habit because of motivation, but the only reason you'll stick with one is that it becomes part of your identity ... Improvements are only temporary until they become part of who you are'—and how you see yourself. Up until now, your goal might have been to learn about how to manage your finances better. If you change your motivation to be rooted in changing your identity, the goal is no longer to learn about financial literacy, but to be someone who is financially independent, someone who has the choice to work or not, someone who is financially confident (or whatever your own end goal is).

In other words, Clear suggests that the creation of this new identity requires new evidence, which we can gain by using his two-step process:

1. Decide the type of person you want to be.
2. Prove it to yourself with small wins.

We've already done some of the work for the first step through the many questions you've been asking yourself in the previous chapters, as we discovered your Money Story, your Money Environment and your Money Type, so that we could identify your unique Financial Phenotype.

How you're going to succeed with the second part—those small wins—is to identify great financial habits you can adopt that support your Financial Phenotype.

The truth of my own personal financial and business success is not that I am smarter or savvier than anyone else. Absolutely not! Instead, I took the time to understand who I am and why I behave the way I do, and was relentless in implementing a series of small, compounding habits, actions and strategies to support my Financial Phenotype. These habits allowed me to play to my strengths and to keep my weaknesses from having any significant impact on my finances.

Here, I want to help you do the same. Remember our conversation in [Chapter 8](#) on financial rip-currents? These habits or systems of behaviour are ones that will work for you (not against you) and help pull you where you want to go.